

# DOCUMENT METADATA

**Document Name:**

MVP FACT SHEET--PRIVACY-SECURITY.pdf

**Title:**

MVP Fact Sheet: Privacy Security

**Topic:**

MVP

**Document Type:**

Presentations and Other Documents

**Created:**

2024-04-02 by Richman, Michael (VACO)

**Modified:**

2024-07-25 by Bartlinski, David



# Privacy and Security Are at the Core of Our Mission



The Million Veteran Program, VA's largest research effort, is inviting Veterans to help us understand how genes, lifestyle, military experiences, and exposures affect health and wellness. More than 1,000,000 Veterans are part of our program—the more Veterans who join, the more discoveries we can make for all people.



## How does MVP code your information?

- MVP uses a unique numeric code for you and the information you provide us via surveys and your Electronic Health Record (EHR). We store the information using this code instead of your name.
- Personally identifiable information (PII), like your name, address, social security number, or date of birth, is only available to a small group of MVP staff. It is not included when your information is used for research.
- Blood samples are stored separately from other information (your survey data and health record data) and assigned a different code. The blood sample is sent to the VA Central Biorepository (see backside for more information) which does not have access to your identifiable information.



## How does MVP protect your information?

- Only VA-approved research projects are granted access to MVP data.
- Information from your blood sample, survey responses, and health records is linked using a code in a way that does not identify you to researchers. This ensures that researchers with approved access to MVP information cannot identify you.
- We do not disclose MVP participants' data, including genetic information, to anyone outside of approved research projects. This means we will never share your information with health insurance companies, group health plans, or employers.



## How does MVP use technology to secure your information?

- All data is stored in secure MVP computing environments—no data leaves the system. All data storage and analysis occurs within VA-approved systems.
- We protect the computers that hold your information with security programs (firewalls), encryption, and password-protection. Our VA computing infrastructure meets VA IT Privacy and Security requirements.



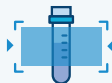
## We keep your blood sample safe and secure

### Where does your blood sample go?



- **SHIPPING**

All MVP blood samples are shipped to the VA Central Biorepository (VACB) via next day shipping.



- **SCANNING**

These laboratories receive and scan the samples for tracking and processing.



- **PROCESSING**

State-of-the-art robotic systems process the samples to prepare them for use in research.



- **QUALITY CONTROL**

We perform quality control on all blood samples, making sure they are high quality and can be included in research studies. If your sample does not pass quality control measures, MVP may contact you to ask for a new sample.



- **ANALYSIS**

We process your blood sample to obtain DNA (genetic material) and prepare it for analysis. This is important so the sample can be turned into information that MVP researchers can use to better understand, prevent, and treat conditions and diseases that affect Veterans.



- **SAFE STORAGE**

VA stores the samples safely and securely. Laboratory access is controlled and only VA-authorized staff are allowed access.



Learn more or join today  
at [mvp.va.gov](https://mvp.va.gov)

**Questions?**

Call 866-441-6075



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